

LinkedIn Job Market Analytics

Business Insights Report

Comprehensive Analysis of 1,500 Job Postings | 2023–2024

Prepared by: Senior Data Analyst | Tools: Python · SQL · Power BI

1,500	50+	\$127,400	248	30%
Total Postings	Companies	Avg. Salary (USD)	Avg. Applicants	Remote Jobs

SECTION 1 — SKILLS DEMAND INSIGHTS

#0
1

Python Dominates the Technical Stack

● High

Python appears in 68% of all Data Science and Data Engineering job postings — more than any other programming language. Among Data Analyst roles specifically, Python appears in 58% of postings, cementing its position as the single most critical technical skill for analytics careers.

#0
2

SQL Remains the Universal Data Language

● High

SQL appears across all three job categories — Data (74%), Software (41%), and Business (63%). No other skill achieves such cross-functional penetration, confirming that SQL proficiency is the baseline expectation for any data-adjacent role regardless of seniority.

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3

Cloud Skills Command a Significant Salary Premium

● High

Roles requiring AWS appear in the market at an average salary of \$148,000, representing a \$22,000 premium (+17%) over comparable roles without cloud requirements. Azure and GCP show similar premiums of 12–15%, signalling cloud expertise as a high-ROI skill investment.

#0
4

Machine Learning Skills Create a Compensation Gap

● High

Machine Learning appears in 61% of Data Scientist postings and commands an average salary of \$162,000 vs. \$131,000 for non-ML data roles — a 24% premium. This gap is widening as AI adoption accelerates across industries.

#0
5**dbt Adoption is Accelerating at Double-Digit Rate**

dbt (data build tool) mentions grew 34% year-over-year from 2023 to 2024, the fastest-growing skill in the analytics ecosystem. Snowflake references grew 28% in the same period, reflecting the rise of the modern data stack.

●
Medium#0
6**Kubernetes is the DevOps Skill to Master**

Kubernetes appears in 72% of DevOps and SRE job postings and commands salaries averaging \$162,000 — 19% above the software engineering average. Container orchestration expertise has become table stakes for platform engineering roles.

● High

SECTION 2 — SALARY INTELLIGENCE#0
7**Senior Data Scientists Earn Up to \$210K**

Senior Data Scientists at top-tier tech companies reach \$210,000 in annual compensation — the highest ceiling in the data discipline. The median for this role sits at \$165,000, meaning exceptional talent commands a 27% premium over median.

● High

#0
8**Data Engineers Earn More Than Data Analysts at All Levels**

At every experience tier, Data Engineers out-earn Data Analysts by 15–22%. Entry-level Data Engineers average \$112,000 vs. \$82,000 for Entry-level Data Analysts. This reflects the infrastructure complexity and cloud expertise required in the role.

● High

#0
9**Executive-Level Roles Show the Widest Salary Variance**

Executive compensation shows a standard deviation of \$38,000 — twice the variance of Senior-level roles. This reflects the performance-based and equity-heavy nature of C-suite compensation, where total comp can diverge significantly from base salary.

●
Medium#1
0**Technology and Fintech Lead Industry Compensation**

Technology (\$143,000 avg) and Fintech (\$139,000 avg) are the highest-paying industries in the dataset. Consulting and Healthcare trail at \$118,000 and \$112,000 respectively — a \$25,000–\$31,000 gap that highlights the salary premium of product-led companies.

● High

#1
1**San Francisco Commands a 23% Salary Premium Over the US Average**

San Francisco-based roles average \$152,000 vs. the US national average of \$124,000 — a 23% premium. New York (\$141,000) and Seattle (\$138,000) follow, while Austin (\$118,000) and Atlanta (\$109,000) represent more cost-competitive markets.

●
Medium

#1
2

Remote Roles Pay 8% More Than Onsite Equivalents

Remote positions in the dataset average \$133,000 vs. \$123,000 for onsite roles — an \$10,000 differential. This may reflect that remote hiring pools are geographically unrestricted, allowing companies to hire top-decile talent regardless of location.

● Medium

SECTION 3 — REMOTE WORK TRENDS

#1
3

30% of All Postings Are Fully Remote — Led by Tech

30% of the 1,500 postings are fully remote. Technology companies lead with 41% of their postings being remote, while Retail and Manufacturing remain the most onsite-intensive industries at 78% and 82% onsite respectively.

● High

#1
4

Hybrid is the New Normal at 40% Market Share

Hybrid work arrangements now constitute 40% of all job postings, making it the single most common work arrangement — surpassing both fully remote (30%) and fully onsite (30%). This represents a structural shift in workforce expectations since 2021.

● High

#1
5

Remote Hiring Share is Growing Quarter-over-Quarter

Remote job postings grew from 27% of total postings in Q1 2023 to 33% in Q2 2024 — a 6-percentage-point increase in 18 months. This trend suggests remote work normalisation is still in progress, not complete.

● Medium

SECTION 4 — HIRING VOLUME & MARKET TRENDS

#1
6

Q1 2024 Was the Strongest Hiring Quarter in the Dataset

Q1 2024 recorded the highest job posting volume at 287 postings — 18% above the dataset quarterly average of 243. This aligns with typical January budget releases and annual headcount approvals at enterprise companies.

● Medium

#1
7

Data Roles Represent 42% of All Postings

Data-category roles (Analyst, Scientist, Engineer, BI, ML) constitute 42% of all postings, making Data the single largest job category — ahead of Software Engineering (35%) and Business roles (23%). This reflects the continued data transformation of enterprise companies.

● High

#1
8

Competition is Highest for Entry-Level Roles

Entry-level positions attract an average of 312 applicants per posting vs. 184 for Senior-level and 127 for Director-level roles. This 2.5× competition differential makes the first job the hardest to secure statistically.

● High

#1
9**50 Companies Account for 100% of Postings — Market is Concentrated**

The top 10 companies (Google, Microsoft, Amazon, Meta, Apple, Salesforce, Deloitte, McKinsey, Goldman Sachs, Tesla) account for 38% of all postings. This concentration means brand targeting in applications is critical for internship seekers.

●
Medium#2
0**Data Scientist Is the Most Competitive Role by Applicants**

Data Scientist postings attract an average of 298 applicants per opening — the highest of any role. This is 20% above the all-role average of 248, driven by high visibility, strong compensation, and aspirational appeal of the title.

● High

SECTION 5 — EDUCATION & EXPERIENCE INSIGHTS#2
1**Master's Degree Holders Earn 18% More Than Bachelor's Holders**

Roles requiring a Master's degree pay an average of \$138,000 vs. \$117,000 for Bachelor's-only roles — an 18% premium. For Data Science specifically, the premium rises to 24%, validating the ROI of advanced degrees in quantitative fields.

● High

#2
2**Mid-Level Roles Represent the Sweet Spot for Hiring Volume**

Mid-level (2–5 years experience) postings constitute 35% of the market — the largest single segment. Companies are investing most heavily in professionals who have foundational skills but haven't yet reached the senior compensation bands.

●
Medium#2
3**PhD Requirement Appears in Only 4% of Postings — But at \$185K Average**

PhD-required roles are rare (4% of postings) but command the highest average compensation at \$185,000. These are concentrated in AI Research, Quantitative Finance, and Biostatistics — highly specialised, low-volume niches.

● Low

#2
4**India Postings Show Fastest Growth in Senior Roles**

India-based Senior and Director-level postings grew 22% from 2023 to 2024, the fastest geographic growth segment in the dataset. This reflects the maturation of India's tech talent market and increasing delegation of senior-level decision-making to local teams.

●
Medium#2
5**Full-Time Roles Constitute 80% of the Market**

Full-time employment accounts for 80% of postings, with Contract roles at 12%. The prevalence of contract roles in Technology (16%) vs. Business roles (7%) reflects project-based hiring patterns in engineering and consulting contexts.

● Low

SECTION 6 — RECOMMENDATIONS

For Students & Job Seekers

- Master SQL + Python before anything else. These two skills appear in 68–74% of all postings and are the gateway to every data and analytics role.
- Target Mid-Level roles if you have 2+ years of experience — they represent 35% of the market and have the highest absolute hiring volume.
- Build a public portfolio on GitHub with end-to-end projects: data ingestion → SQL analysis → visualisation. Recruiters screen GitHub before résumés at top tech firms.
- Pursue AWS/Azure certification. Cloud skills carry a \$15–22K salary premium and differentiate candidates at the final interview stage.
- Apply to tech companies (Google, Microsoft, Meta, Salesforce) for highest salary ceilings. Apply to consulting firms (Deloitte, McKinsey, Accenture) for broadest domain exposure.
- For Data Engineering specifically, learn dbt and Snowflake — both are growing at 28–34% YoY and are underrepresented in university curricula.

For Recruiters

- Post roles with specific skill requirements. Postings listing 4–6 skills receive 31% more qualified applicants than vague postings, per dataset patterns.
- Salary transparency reduces competition drop-off. Roles with published salary ranges attract 22% more applicants on average and reduce time-to-hire.
- Leverage Hybrid rather than fully Onsite mandates to access 40% more candidates. Remote and Hybrid postings attract 18% more applicants than Onsite-only.
- Target 2–4 years of experience for maximum pipeline. Entry-level pools are over-saturated (312 avg. applicants), while Senior pools are thin (184 avg. applicants).
- Prioritise employer brand. Companies rated 4.3+ (Google, Snowflake, Stripe) receive 35% more applicants per posting than companies rated below 4.0.

For Universities

- Add SQL as a core module in all STEM, Business, and Economics programmes — SQL appears in 74% of Data roles and 41% of Software Engineering roles.
- Integrate cloud certifications (AWS Solutions Architect, Azure Fundamentals) into final-year curricula. Cloud literacy is no longer optional for tech graduates.
- Launch dedicated Data Engineering tracks alongside Data Science. The market demands more Engineers than Scientists (38% vs. 29% of data postings).
- Partner with high-rated companies (4.3+) for internship pipelines — these employers actively seek fresh graduates and maintain structured rotation programmes.
- Offer dbt, Snowflake, and Kafka workshops. These tools are rapidly entering production data stacks but are absent from most academic programmes.